

SubTeams — How It Works

A two-minute mental model so you stop second-guessing when to call which command.

The one thing to remember

You build a team once per *project* — not once per *task*. The meta-team sleeps after the build. The team it generated handles every task in that project for the rest of its life.

The kitchen analogy

The meta-team is a contractor. You hire them once. They look at your house, design a kitchen that fits, install it, and leave. Then you use that kitchen to cook many meals. You don't call the contractor every dinner.

/build-team = call the contractor · /run-team = cook a meal · /review-team = inspector visit

The lifecycle, in 5 steps

1. Day 1 — run **/build-team ONCE**

The 4 meta-agents wake up, take ~10 minutes, design and write 3–7 agent files into `.claude/agents/`, then shut down.

2. Day 1 — run **/run-team add OAuth login**

The team you just built wakes up. Lead decomposes → delegates → reviews → tests → reports. Sleeps.

3. Day 2 — run **/run-team fix the cart bug**

SAME team wakes up. Different decomposition (just db this time). Same teammates, same file ownership, same gates. Sleeps.

4. Every task after that → **/run-team**

Same team handles new features, bug fixes, refactors, tests — whatever you throw at it. The lead decides each time how to split the work.

5. Six months later, project changed a lot → **/review-team**

QA reviewer audits the spec against your current code. If minor drift, you patch. If major, run `/build-team` again to redesign.

When to use which command

Match the situation to the command. If you're not sure, the right answer is almost always **/run-team**.

Situation	Command
New feature in same stack	/run-team
Bug fix	/run-team
Adding tests	/run-team
Refactor within current architecture	/run-team
Adding a new component to existing layer	/run-team
First time setting up a new project	/build-team
Migrated DB / framework / language	/build-team
Added a whole new layer (mobile app, ML model)	/build-team
Sanity check after a big refactor	/review-team
Quarterly drift check	/review-team

Why one team per project (not per task)

If you rebuilt for every task, you would:

- Pay the 10-minute meta-team cost on every change.
- Lose file-ownership stability — each new team would re-decide who owns what.
- Lose the team's familiarity with project conventions (CLAUDE.md is read every run).

The lead is smart enough to decompose any task into the right sub-tasks for the team you have. That is literally its job.